IRVINGTON HIGH SCHOOL PTSA · FREMONT, CA

Safe and Savvy: Cyber Safety for Irvington Families

A parent's playbook for the age of AI



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A little about me

Adjunct Faculty, Merritt College
Teaching the next generation of tech talent

Software & cybersecurity leader
Optum, UnitedHealth Group, Microsoft

O’Reilly author & patent holder

Security Engineer at Lib13
We work with funded startups

Hobbies
Maker, mountaineer, cyclist, public art

Today's roadmap

JOIN IN

1. **Scams: is it really them?**
   Voice clones, fake "police" calls, the family password, game-cheat malware
2. **Privacy and location**
   Meet Maya: what a stranger can piece together
3. **Group chats, bullying and apps**
   What to say, which apps to know, three questions for any app
4. **AI: faked images and chatbots**
   What to do if it happens, and why a chatbot is a tool, not a friend
5. **Parenting: agree as a family**
   A family media agreement, one action for tonight, dinner-table questions

Every part starts with a question for the chat. Bonus side note: careers in cybersecurity. If there's interest, we'll do another seminar in more detail.

Give a thumbs-up if…

REACT



You use the same password on more than one account



You got a suspicious text or call this month

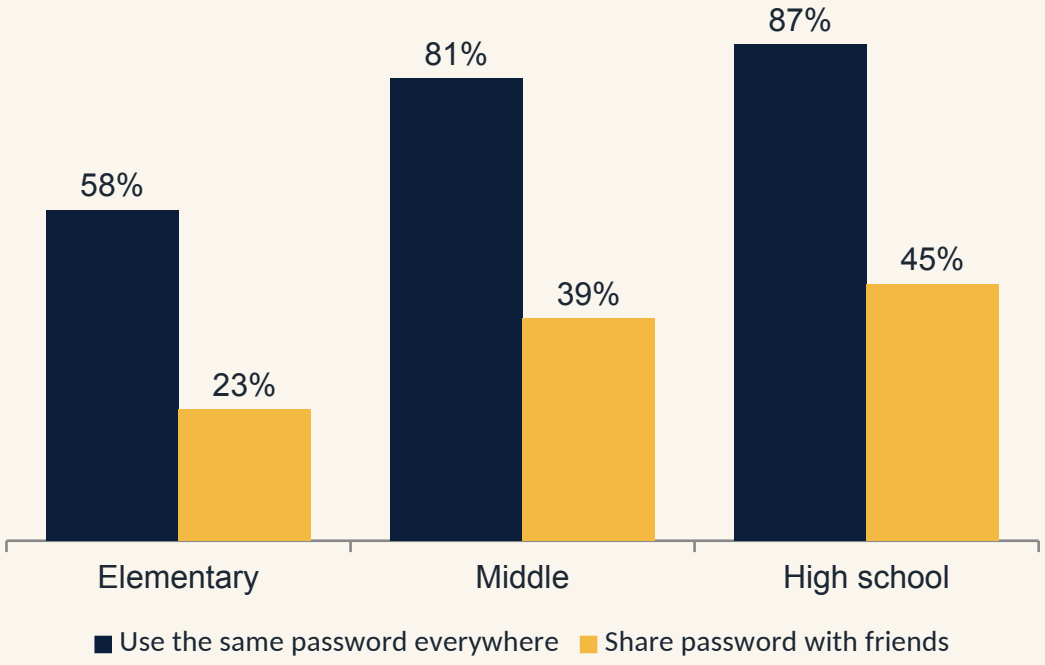


Your teen games on a computer you also use



Your teen is more tech-savvy than you

Teens know the rules. Habits lag behind.



1,505

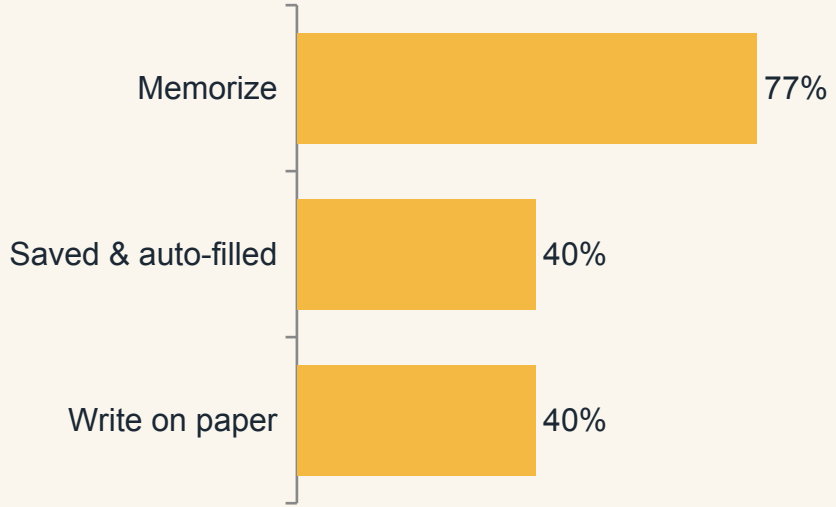
students (grades 3–12) surveyed by NIST

98% of high schoolers say passwords should be kept private, yet 45% share them with friends.

Let a manager remember for you

ACTION #2

How parents keep track of passwords



NIST survey of 265 parents; multiple answers allowed. Only 12% change passwords by account type; 53% only when needed.

One unique password per account

NIST found parents have fewer passwords than accounts, so reuse creeps in.

One strong master password

Add 2-step login to the manager itself. It is the only one to remember.

Autofill is a fake-site alarm

A manager won't fill a login on a look-alike site, a useful warning sign.

Apple Passwords (iCloud), Google Password Manager, 1Password, Bitwarden: any works. Pick one this month.

Digital natives still need a guide

Savvy users, not security experts

NIST: skills built from constant use may not go beyond texting, social media and browsing. Teens trust what they find on the web.

47% → 13%

Parents who always help with passwords: elementary vs. high school

We step back just as the stakes rise. Teens still need a safety net, now as a partner.

“We’ve had all those conversations, but it’s been years. I honestly don’t know what he knows at this point.”

Parent of a high schooler, NIST interviews. Parents often underestimate what teens know and care about.

PART 1 OF 5

Scams: is it really them?

AI can copy a voice. Start with what you have already seen.

LET'S TALK

Has a call, text or message made you pause this month? Type it in the chat. No names needed.

Zoom reaction: thumbs-up if it has happened to your family.

How a teen's identity gets copied

IN CHAT

1

Voice

A few seconds of audio from a public video, story or game stream can be enough to copy it.

2

Face

Public photos and school or team posts can be used in AI-edited or faked images.

3

Details

A name, school and schedule from public profiles make a fake message believable.

THE SETUP The copy sounds right, knows your name, and arrives with urgency.

IN CHAT Where could a stranger hear or see your teen online today?

It sounds like your kid. It isn’t.

1. Grab

A few seconds of a teen’s voice from a public video, game stream or story

2. Clone

Cheap AI tools copy the voice. Caller ID can be faked too

3. Panic

“Mom, I’m in trouble. Don’t tell Dad. Send money now.”

Red flags

- Urgency and secrecy
- Payment by wire, crypto or gift cards
- A “new number” or a stranger “helping”
- Fremont PD: no official demands money right away for a family member’s safety
- You can’t trust your ears. Verify another way

When “the police” call too

REACT

Spoofed police calls

Scammers fake caller ID, even the non-emergency line, (510) 790-6800. Officers never call to ask for money. Hang up.

Call your family first

No official demands money right away for a family member’s safety. Call your family to confirm they’re OK.

Scary texts with your details

A name and address feel personal but are widely available. Don’t reply. Call your family.

Agree who calls whom

Pick one person to call first, such as the other parent or a grandparent. Tell your teen, so they know you will check.

Report it: Fremont PD online or (510) 790-6800 option 3 · reportfraud.ftc.gov · FBI IC3

Real or scam? Vote in chat.

IN CHAT

A

Call: your teen's voice, crying

"I got into an accident. Don't tell Dad. I need $2,000 today."

B

Call from "Fremont PD"

"You missed a subpoena. Pay this fine now or be arrested."

C

DM from a classmate's account

"Try my new game! Also, send me the code you just got."

The twist: all three are scams. Voice, caller ID and even a friend's account are no longer proof. What is?

The Family Password

IN CHAT

A shared secret that proves it’s really them

1

Pick it together

Everyone in the family, including grandparents who may be called

2

Make it random

Three unrelated words, like purple-tractor-waffle

3

Keep it offline

Never typed, texted or posted. Say it out loud only

4

Ask, don’t offer

The caller must say it. If they can’t, hang up and call back

Chat (2 min): how will you pitch this to your teen? Skip pet names, birthdays and anything on social media.

In the news: the “free cheat” trap

BleepingComputer · Aug 3, 2026

Fake Roblox Xeno script launcher pushes infostealer, RAT malware

Steals browser logins, cookies, payment data and crypto wallets. Can watch the webcam.

Malwarebytes · Jun 17, 2026

Roblox developers are losing entire games to malware attacks

One “job offer” file on Discord. Stolen sessions can sidestep two-step login.

TechCrunch · Jul 17, 2026

FBI arrests man accused of using Steam games to drain victims’ crypto wallets

About 8,000 infected devices and $220K+ stolen. Not Roblox, same trick.

Bitdefender to parents: many Roblox “executors” (cheat tools) are really delivery vehicles for malware.

How a cheat reaches Dad's accounts



1. Lure

"Free Robux" or an "undetected" cheat tool on YouTube, Discord or forums



2. Run

Your teen runs the file on the family PC. It looks like the real tool



3. Steal

Saved passwords, login cookies, payment info and crypto wallets from the browser



4. Drain

Anyone logged in on that browser, including Dad's email, shopping or bank, is exposed

Why two-step login isn't enough: stolen login cookies can let attackers in without a password. Sign out of all sessions after an infection.

Which download is safe?

IN CHAT

A

Roblox from roblox.com or the official app store

B

An “undetected” executor from a YouTube link

C

A free Robux generator a Discord friend shared

Only A. Roblox bans executors, and “free” cheat tools are a common way malware gets in.

Already ran one? Unplug it from the network. From a clean device, change passwords, sign out of all sessions, and call your bank.

PART 2 OF 5

Privacy and location

Each post is harmless. Together they tell a story.

LET'S TALK

How much could a stranger learn about your teen from their public profile?

Zoom reaction: thumbs-up if you have looked at your teen's public profile this year.

Meet Maya (she's fictional)

IN CHAT

@maya.k16 · public account

1. Go Irvington! Team hoodie photo after the game
2. Soccer every Tue and Thu at 4. Come watch!
3. Sweet 16 on March 14!!
4. New room reveal. House number 2217 visible by the door
5. Live story: at Fremont BART right now

Chat challenge (2 min)

- Where does she live?
- Where will she be, and when?
- When is she probably alone?
- What could a stranger guess about her passwords?

Each post is harmless. Together they answer who, where and when. Fremont PD notes that knowing a family's school or sports routine suggests someone is watching.

Privacy and location: fix it together



Audience

- Posts and stories: friends only
- Prune followers they haven't met in person
- Hide the friends list if the app allows



Location

- Snap Map: Ghost Mode ("only me")
- Share live location with trusted people only
- Post outings after you've left



Permissions

- Location: "while using" or off
- Mic, camera, contacts: only if needed
- Parents: review your own posts too

Do it together, not to them: open one app tonight and tour its settings side by side. Five minutes.

PART 3 OF 5

Group chats and apps

Where teens talk is where problems start, and where help can start too.

LET'S TALK

Type the app your teen uses most. Is it one you use too?

In the chat: add one app you have heard of but never opened.

Group chats and cyberbullying

Pew (2022): 46% of US teens have experienced at least one type of cyberbullying.



Don’t respond or retaliate

A reaction is often what the bully wants, and hitting back can escalate it



Save the evidence

Screenshot messages, usernames and dates. Never keep explicit images



Block and report

Use the app’s block and report tools. It may not end it, but it removes the temptation



Tell a trusted adult

For threats of harm, involve the school and local police

Parents: listen first. You’re lucky if they ask for help. Respond thoughtfully, not fast, and banning the app rarely fixes it.

Group chats: bystanders matter. Don’t forward a humiliating screenshot. Support the target, report it, tell a school adult.

Apps parents should know about

REACT

Messaging & video chat

Discord, Kik, WhatsApp, Reddit, Holla, Ask.fm, Hot or Not

Strangers can reach your teen. Many have no identity checks.

Content sharing

Snapchat, TikTok, Live.me

“Disappearing” posts, limited privacy controls, location features.

Secret apps

Calculator%, Whisper

Look harmless. Hide photos and files, or share anonymous secrets.

Dating apps

Badoo, Bumble, Grindr, MeetMe, Skout

Built for adults, but teens are known to fake their age.

Which have you never heard of? Games count too: Roblox, Minecraft, Fortnite and their Discord servers.

Three questions for any app

IN CHAT

1

Who can contact my teen?

Strangers, or only friends? Check who can message and send friend requests.

2

Who can see where they are?

Live location, maps, tagged posts and check-ins. Set it to friends or off.

3

What can hide or disappear?

Disappearing messages, secret apps and anonymous chats are harder to review.

THE POINT You do not need to know every app. Ask the same three questions of each one.

IN CHAT Pick one app your teen uses. Can you answer all three? Thumbs-up if yes.

Practical controls that help

Phones and tablets

Apple Screen Time or Google Family Link: apps, contacts, purchases

Consoles and router

Same controls for games, downloads and who can contact them

App settings

Who can message, public vs. private, purchases, recovery email

Accounts

Password manager, 2-step login, own login for each gamer

Chatbots

Controls vary a lot by app. Check before you allow it

Updates

Automatic updates, antivirus, standard (non-admin) kid accounts

Features vary by device and account setup. The conversation does the real work.

PART 4 OF 5

AI: faked images and chatbots

Two new things parents did not grow up with.

LET'S TALK

Has your teen used an AI chatbot? Have you asked what for?

Zoom reaction: thumbs-up if your teen uses one. Thumbs-up if you have asked what for.

AI-faked images and blackmail

Tell your teen beforehand: a fake still causes real harm, and the target deserves help, not blame.



1. Don’t share or send more

No forwarding. Never send more photos to a blackmailer



2. Tell an adult, no blame

Thank your teen for telling you. Stay calm



3. Report it

To the app, and to NCMEC’s CyberTipline (report.cybertip.org)



4. Get it removed

takeitdown.ncmec.org: free, for under 18, parents can start it

If someone demands money: don’t pay or send more. Keep the threats and account names (not the image), then report.

What would you do?

IN CHAT

Your teen says a classmate's AI-edited photo is going around a group chat.

A

Screenshot it and forward it to the parents' group chat

B

Thank them for telling you. Don't share it. Report it and tell the school

C

Tell them to stay out of it

B. Forwarding spreads the harm, and silence leaves the target alone. Praise your teen for telling you.

AI chatbots are tools, not friends

Why teens like them

Private, always available, flattering. Common Sense Media: 3 in 4 teens have tried AI companions, 1 in 3 chose AI over a person for a serious talk, 1 in 4 shared personal information.

The risks

- Teens can bond as if it were a real person
- May replace friends, worsening isolation
- Agreeable bots can reinforce unsafe ideas
- Flirty or sexual content can appear

What to do

- Talk openly. Ask what they use it for
- Try it together
- Set clear rules and limits
- Teach: a tool, not a friend or therapist
- Watch for mood changes and pulling away
- Worried? Call your pediatrician

Agree on what stays private: family details, addresses, passwords

PART 5 OF 5

Parenting: agree as a family

Tools help, but the conversation does the real work.

LET'S TALK

What is one house rule about screens that actually works for your family?

In the chat: type one rule. Steal a rule from someone else's answer.

Why write the rules down?

TALK ABOUT IT

1

No surprises

Everyone knows the rules before something goes wrong, so the talk is about the plan, not about blame.

2

Teens help write it

Rules your teen helped make are easier to follow than rules handed down.

3

It can change

Review it each school year and every summer, as your teen and the apps change.

AAP The American Academy of Pediatrics suggests a family media use plan for every family.

TALK ABOUT IT Ask your teen: which of our screen rules feels the most unfair? Start there.

A family media agreement

YOUR TURN

1. Screen-free times and places: dinner, homework, bedtime
2. One screen at a time
3. Notifications and autoplay off
4. Check privacy settings before any new app
5. Make room for sports, reading, friends, hobbies
6. Adults follow the same rules, dinner included

Review it each school year and every summer. Teens help write it.

Our Family Agreement

Screens off at _____

Phones charge in _____

If something goes wrong, I will _____

We review this on _____

Signed: parents _____ teens _____

Parenting digital natives

Stay current

Keep up with online risks and dangers

Keep a resource list

One set of trusted sites for the whole family

Walk the talk

Get your own security habits right first

Start early

Make good online behavior second nature

Talk about good and bad

Friendships and fun, plus threats and risks

Think critically

Question what you find online, in email, chat and social

Seven actions: pick one

YOUR TURN

1

Verify unusual requests independently

Hang up, call back, use the family password

2

Protect accounts and keep login codes private

Password manager: iCloud, Google, 1Password

3

Check opportunities before sending money or information

Fake internships, giveaways, free cheats

4

Review audiences, location and app permissions together

Profile, Snap Map, mic and camera

5

Refuse to amplify bullying or intimate images

Don’t forward, don’t pile on

6

Agree on AI use and healthy device boundaries

Chatbots are tools, not friends

7

Make asking for help easy, and have a response plan

“You won’t be in trouble for telling me”

Tonight I will…

Pick ONE. Post it in the chat.

At the dinner table

TONIGHT

Pick one to ask tonight

- “What’s the weirdest message you’ve ever gotten?”
- “If I called you in trouble, how would you know it was me?”
- “Show me your favorite game. Where do cheats and mods come from?”
- “What do you use AI chatbots for?”
- “If a mean or fake photo of someone got shared, what would you do?”
- **Stay calm. Just saying “no” rarely works**

Trusted resources

ConnectSafely

connectsafely.org

Family Online Safety Institute

fosi.org

iKeepSafe

ikeepsafe.org

StaySafeOnline

staysafeonline.org

Bookmark one tonight.

Start with one tonight

1. Set the family password together
2. Tour one app’s privacy and location settings
3. Fill in the family media agreement

Questions?

If there’s interest, we’ll do another seminar in more detail.

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Backup slides

Bonus side note: careers in cybersecurity. Use if there is time or interest.

Bonus: a career worth knowing

500,000+

unfilled U.S. cybersecurity jobs, per CyberSeek

Many students never see it as an option, because they picture a hoodie-wearing hacker.

Side note. If there's interest, we'll do another seminar in more detail.

Myth vs. reality

~~Only for coders and math whizzes~~

Also law, policy, teaching, investigating, communications

~~Hackers in dark rooms~~

Protecting hospitals, schools, cars and power grids

~~Solo work~~

Teams of analysts, builders and communicators

Try it, explore it, get started

Try it (free)

- TryCyber.us: hands-on challenges
- Cyber clubs and competitions at school
- National Cyber League, NCAE Cyber Games

Explore roles

- CyberSeek.org: jobs and career maps
- Technical and non-technical paths
- Start from interests, not job titles

Start at Merritt

- AS or certificate: Infrastructure or Applications Security
- Free CyberCamp for high schoolers
- BangNull club competes in the National Cyber League

Tip for teens: ask “what problem do I want to protect people from?” before “what job do I want?”

Announcement: Techs on Decks

Nov 14, 2026 · 10 AM – 5 PM

USS Hornet Sea, Air & Space Museum

- **Free for students and educators with ID.**
- Hands-on STEM: compass navigation, robotics, skyscraper construction, live demos.
- Early registrants get 1-hour docent-led tours: Flight Deck, Engine Room, Power Generation, Navigation, Combat Information Center.
- Free pizza from Domino's.
- Sponsored by the Community of Information Systems Executives (CISE).

Register with the QR code on the flyer. Great for teens curious about tech.

